First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 12
Sacred Earth, Sacred Soul ~ Sacred Gratitude
22 November 2026

COMMUNION

Preaching: LVF
Worship Leading: ML & …

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Michael and … to center chancel]

Welcome **ML**

Words of Gathering **ML &**

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn Of Gathering**

[Michael center chancel]

Prayer of Awareness **ML**

[All turn towards choir]

Introit

[... to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**
Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Michael center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace** **ML**

Peace for the world and its peoples
peace for those who do not know peace
peace for those who pray for peace.

The peace of heaven's vastness
the peace of ocean depths
the peace of earth's stillness
to bless all creation this day
to bless all creation this day.

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

[... to lectern]

Reading from Our Religious Tradition ***from the Gospel of Mark***

This is the Gospel of Love and Grace.
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph transition Michael to center chancel]

Prayers with the People **ML**

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

Silence

[2 minutes of silence, then Christoph transition out of silence]

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Christoph transition for Laude]

Meditation Anthem

[Christoph transition Laura to pulpit]

Sermon ***Sacred Gratitude*** **LVF**

[Christoph transition as Michael & Laura go behind communion table]

The Eucharist and Blessings **LVF & ML**

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

You are welcome at this table if you have a little faith, a lot of faith, absolutely no faith, or are of another faith. This is the Table of the Christ, and the welcome is wide!

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup
At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

[... to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

You will find information for online giving in your programs and appearing on your screens at home. Our Hospitality Team will also come forward now to receive your offerings. Thank you for your ongoing generosity through the resources, time, and talents you bring to strengthen our community to be the Love of the Divine in the world.

Offertory

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!
[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[... to lectern]

***Prayer of Offering**

Please be seated

[Michael and Laura center chancel]

Life at First Church **LVF & ML**

Words of Blessing **LVF**

Choral Response

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music - Dr. Ianthe Marini